

OCBC Bank

First take: 1Q26 in line with Street, weak NII and limited capital management to limit upside

Our First Take: OCBC reported 1Q26 profits of S\$1.97bn, up 5% y/y, 13% q/q, 1% above JPMe and in-line with Street (our 2026E EPS is 2% below Bloomberg). NII missed by 2%, despite faster growth in loans and deposits, with 28/10bps y/y and q/q NIM compression. Management reiterated 2026 guidance of “slight to moderate decline in NII”, which is a source of risk for Street estimates. Non-II was a 2% beat. Yet, post GEH, DBS and UOB results, this was almost fully discounted. Insurance and trading were better. Importantly, most of the treasury strength came from flow business, which is a significant positive. A key question is the sustainability of non-II strength, which likely has legs. We forecast 3% revenue growth for this year, almost in line with guidance (“total income stable to growing”). CIR was a touch better at 50.2%, led by non-II as costs were 1% higher. PPoP was 1% below JPMe. AQ was quite strong, with NPLs down q/q (0.9% NPL ratio), with much lower formation. Accordingly, credit costs at 25bps were lower, and most of this was for non-impaired assets. This suggests a higher quality of LLR, which may be used later on to support the bottom line, if need be. CET1 came in at 15.2% (14.2% adj for 2025 DPS). Management reiterated 50% payout and completing the S\$2.5bn capital return plan by FY26. S\$780mn of buyback budget is remaining, which we assume will all be paid as special. That will get us to about 60% payout for the year. We expect the stock to be weak on the NII miss and payout guidance.

Industry read-through

Post the results season, we remain positive on DBS ([link](#)), with a degree of caution on OCBC on limited capital return and NII-led risk to Street estimates. UOB stays our least preferred stock, despite low valuations. The investment thesis for Singapore banks is anchored by four variables: 1) NII growth amidst rate declines (hedging, mix shift, and NIM vs. NII); 2) strong non-II led by NNM gr, capital markets and banca; 3) steady AQ; and 4) high and steady dividend payouts. We hold OW on DBS, and UW on OCBC and UOB.

Key Positives

Non-II was a key area of strength with insurance, fees, and trading all delivering good y/y growth. Asset quality was stable with the bulk of allowances for non-impaired assets and NPA coverage increasing to 163% from 151%.

Key Negatives/Question Marks

NII declined 3% q/q, with NIM contracting a sharp 10bps q/q, significantly higher than peers (DBS -4bps, UOB -2bps q/q). Cost increase was slightly higher than our forecast (+6% y/y).

See page 5 for analyst certification and important disclosures, including non-US analyst disclosures.

Underweight

OCBC.SI, OCBC.SP

Price (06 May 26): S\$22.00

Price Target (Jun-27): S\$20.00

**FIRST
TAKE**



APAC Banks

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Likely Changes to Consensus

We expect limited changes to Street FY26 estimates post results.

Expected Stock Reaction

We expect a negative near-term reaction.

Conference Call Details

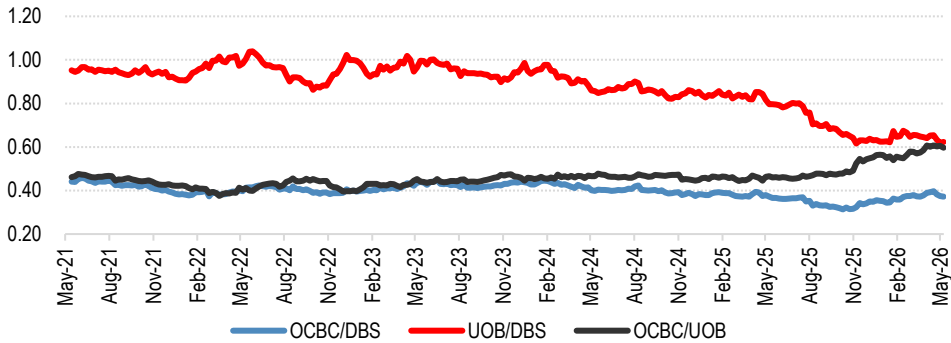
OCBC is holding a media briefing at 9:15am SGT and an analyst briefing at 10:30am SGT on 8th May, 2026. Please let us know if you'd like to register.

Table 1: OCBC: 1Q26 earnings review

P&L (\$\$mn)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26A	1Q26E	YoY	QoQ	JPMe
Net Interest Income	2,345	2,283	2,226	2,296	2,222	2,274	-5%	-3%	-2%
Non-Interest Income	1,310	1,264	1,570	1,320	1,606	1,568	23%	22%	2%
Net Fee Income	546	580	683	602	675	722	24%	12%	-7%
Operating Revenue	3,655	3,547	3,796	3,616	3,828	3,842	5%	6%	0%
Operating Costs	(1,415)	(1,389)	(1,519)	(1,559)	(1,505)	(1,484)	6%	-3%	1%
PPOP	2,240	2,158	2,277	2,057	2,323	2,358	4%	13%	-1%
Provisions	(212)	(114)	(139)	(200)	(216)	(258)	2%	8%	-16%
Associates	274	263	279	261	312	300	14%	20%	4%
Amortization, tax, NCI	(419)	(491)	(439)	(373)	(445)	(443)	6%	19%	0%
Net Attributable Profit	1,883	1,816	1,978	1,745	1,974	1,957	5%	13%	1%
Gross Loans	322,175	324,606	327,060	341,120	347,000	344,207	8%	2%	1%
Net Loans	317,885	320,413	322,729	336,692	342,756	339,649	8%	2%	1%
Deposits	402,732	406,943	410,596	428,286	443,808	437,014	10%	4%	2%
NPL	2,898	2,983	2,944	3,229	3,123	3,272	8%	-3%	-5%
LLR	4,290	4,193	4,331	4,428	4,587	4,558	7%	4%	1%
							Change in bps		
NIM	2.04%	1.92%	1.84%	1.86%	1.76%	1.82%	(28)	(10)	(6)
CIR	38.7%	39.2%	40.0%	43.1%	39.3%	38.6%	60	(380)	69
LDR	80.0%	79.8%	79.7%	79.6%	78.2%	78.8%	(181)	(146)	(58)
CASA Ratio	48.9%	49.8%	50.3%	50.7%	50.2%	51.0%	130	(54)	(76)
Credit Costs (bps)	26	11	17	27	25	30	(1)	(2)	(5)
NPL Ratio	0.90%	0.92%	0.90%	0.95%	0.90%	0.95%	0	(5)	(5)
Coverage Ratio	148%	141%	147%	137%	147%	139%	(115)	976	757
CET1 (Fully phased-in)	15.5%	15.3%	15.0%	15.1%	15.2%	15.7%	(30)	12	(51)
DPS (\$\$)	0.00	0.41	0.00	0.58	0.00	0.00	NM	-100%	NM

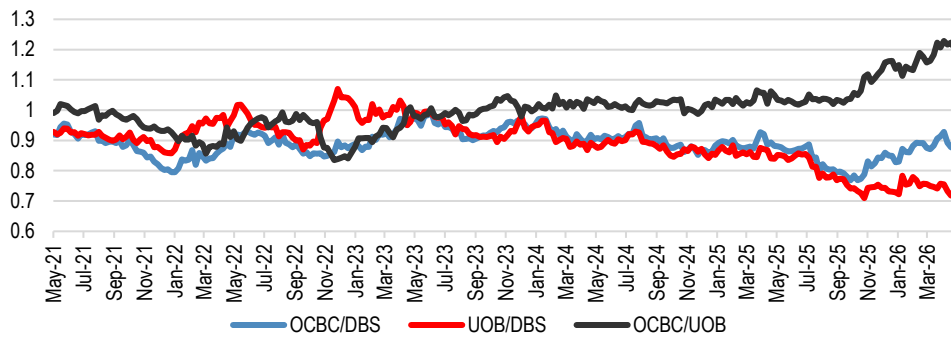
Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates.

Figure 1: SG banks – relative prices



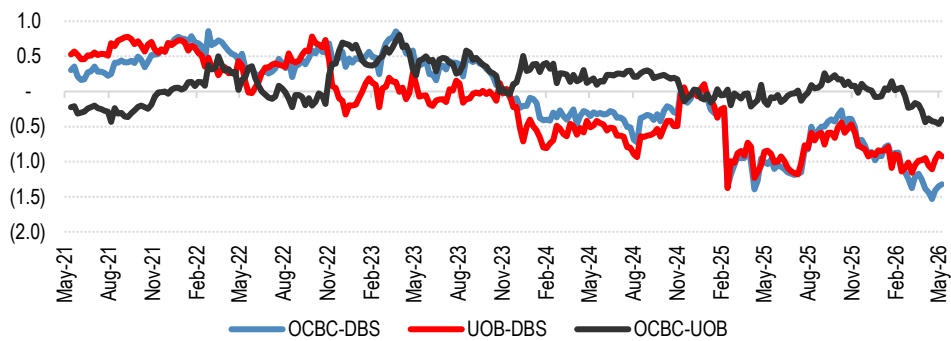
Source: Bloomberg Finance, L.P., J.P. Morgan.

Figure 2: SG banks – relative PER



Source: Bloomberg Finance, L.P., J.P. Morgan.

Figure 3: SG banks – relative dividend yield spread



Source: Bloomberg Finance, L.P., J.P. Morgan.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

OCBC Bank *(Underweight; Price Target: S\$20.00)*

Investment Thesis

We are UW on OCBC.

- The bank has built a multi-brand financial conglomerate in Asia, with Wing Hang, BoS, GEH and Bank of Ningbo being the main acquisitions/stake increases in the last 20 years, with Lion Global being a product of the merger between OCBC/GEH AMs. The group is generating 1.08% RoA with ~11x leverage in 2026E.
- The track-record suggests OCBC is more likely to use excess capital to buy rather than increase payout significantly. While management is committed to the current S\$2.5bn capital return plan, visibility for further increases in payout is low in 2026. Further, the bank's track record on inorganic growth could lead to near-term risks if growth is via inorganic means and transactions are not immediately accretive.
- We expect S\$1 DPS in 2026. This assumes 50% regular payout, as well as pay out of the remaining S\$780mn as special dividend. Beyond FY26, we expect the bank to sustain total payout close to 60%.
- The bank is benefitting from significant inflows of funds into Singapore, and in SGD. This should support NII, though reduction in credit spreads is a risk given macro uncertainties. We expect 1.77% NIM in FY26 vs. 1.91% in FY25.
- Risk-reward has turned negative following the stock price strength in last 1M. The stock is trading at 1.61x 2026E PB for ~12% ROE.

Valuation

Our Jun-27 PT of S\$20 is based on a fair P/B of 1.3x, assuming a normalized RoE of 11.9%, a risk-free rate of 4.1%, a cost of capital of 10.2% and a growth rate of 4.3%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include a significant improvement in DPS, a meaningfully value-accretive deal, better than-expected growth at GE, and better-than-expected WM fees. Bank of Ningbo (20%-owned by OCBC) has competitive advantages in local SMEs and high-net-worth retail clients, which could drive faster growth at the group.

Further downside risks include weaker than expected NIM, market share losses in wealth management, lack of increases in capital return, and M&A, if transactions are not immediately accretive.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 06 May 2026, unless otherwise indicated)
DBS Group Holdings(DBSM.SI/S\$58.85/OW), United Overseas Bank (UOB)(UOBH.SI/S\$36.65/UW)

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OCBC Bank (OCBC.SI, OCBC SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
13-Mar-24	UW	13.09	12.5
10-May-24	NR	13.91	--
13-Jul-25	N	16.89	18
08-Aug-25	N	17.09	17.5
10-Sep-25	N	16.76	17
28-Nov-25	OW	18.27	20
09-Jan-26	N	20.17	20.5
03-Apr-26	UW	22.38	20

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Feb 24, 2000. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

DBS Group Holdings (DBSM.SI, DBS SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
05-Oct-23	UW	30.20	28
09-Dec-23	UW	28.73	27.5
13-Mar-24	N	30.46	30
03-Jul-24	OW	37.10	41
06-Oct-24	OW	38.04	42
10-Nov-24	OW	42.40	50
11-Feb-25	OW	45.38	51
23-Mar-25	OW	45.31	49
21-May-25	N	44.38	47
13-Jul-25	N	45.99	48
08-Aug-25	N	49.75	50.5
10-Sep-25	OW	50.88	56
28-Nov-25	OW	54.00	70
03-Apr-26	OW	57.55	63
17-Apr-26	OW	57.30	62
07-May-26	OW	58.85	64

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 11, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

United Overseas Bank (UOB) (UOBH.SI, UOB SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
05-Oct-23	N	28.07	28
09-Dec-23	N	27.58	27
13-Mar-24	N	28.28	30
03-Jul-24	N	31.65	32.5
06-Oct-24	N	31.86	34
10-Nov-24	OW	35.69	41
14-Jan-25	OW	36.80	43
23-Mar-25	N	37.95	40
21-May-25	N	35.40	37
13-Jul-25	N	36.86	38
08-Aug-25	N	35.81	36.5
10-Sep-25	UW	35.57	32.5
28-Nov-25	N	33.89	34
25-Jan-26	UW	39.50	34
17-Apr-26	UW	37.52	33

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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